

APPENDIX B: COMPREHENSIVE METAPHOR LEXICON BY AFFECT TYPE

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1. INTRODUCTION AND USAGE GUIDE

Purpose

This lexicon catalogs embodied metaphors that reveal core feeling states in language. It serves as a reference for:

- **Detection systems:** Identifying affect markers in text
- **Researchers:** Understanding metaphorical expressions of affect
- **Auditors:** Verifying detection accuracy
- **Clinicians:** Recognizing affect patterns in client language

Structure

Each affect section contains:

Verbs: Action words expressing the bodily experience **Adjectives:** Descriptive words for states and qualities

Nouns: Objects and concepts used metaphorically **Phrases:** Common multi-word expressions

Intensity Gradients: Mild → Moderate → Extreme **Syntactic Patterns:** Common grammatical structures **Contextual Markers:** Words that amplify or modify meaning

Usage Notes

Disambiguation: Some words appear in multiple affects. Context determines actual affect:

- "Cold" = fear (cold dread) OR dissmell (cold shoulder) OR lack of joy (cold response)
- "Heavy" = distress (heavy burden) OR shame (heavy with guilt)
- Always check surrounding language

Negation: Negated metaphors may indicate absence or presence:

- "Not frozen" = fear absent
- "Can't breathe" = distress present (despite negation word)

Cultural variation: Metaphors vary by culture (see Section 11)

Intensity indicators: ALL CAPS, !!! exclamation points, repetition amplify intensity

2. FEAR-TERROR METAPHORS

Bodily Experience Base

Fear manifests as: rapid heart rate, cold sensation, muscle freezing/tension, shallow breathing, stomach dropping, hair standing up, wide eyes, pale skin.

Verbs

Freezing/Paralysis (Intensity: Moderate to Extreme):

- freeze, froze, frozen
- paralyze, paralyzed
- petrify, petrified
- immobilize, immobilized
- lock up, locked up
- seize, seized up
- stiffen, stiffened

- stop dead

Trapping/Confinement (Intensity: Moderate to Extreme):

- trap, trapped
- corner, cornered
- cage, caged
- confine, confined
- imprison, imprisoned
- catch, caught
- snare, snared
- ensnare, ensnared

Fleeing/Escape (Intensity: Mild to Moderate):

- flee, fled
- run, running
- escape, escaping
- retreat, retreating
- hide, hiding
- duck, ducking

Shaking/Trembling (Intensity: Mild to Extreme):

- shake, shaking, shook
- tremble, trembling
- shudder, shuddering
- quake, quaking
- quiver, quivering

Adjectives

Temperature (Cold):

- cold (cold dread, cold fear)
- chilled, chilling
- icy
- frozen
- frigid

Physical State:

- paralyzed
- frozen
- petrified
- terrified

- horrified
- panicked
- scared stiff
- white (with fear)
- pale
- clammy

Intensity Levels:

- **Mild:** nervous, worried, anxious, uneasy, jittery, jumpy
- **Moderate:** scared, frightened, afraid, fearful, alarmed
- **Extreme:** terrified, petrified, horrified, panic-stricken, terror-stricken

Nouns and Noun Phrases

Physical Sensations:

- cold sweat, cold dread
- knot in stomach
- lump in throat
- hair standing on end
- goosebumps, gooseflesh
- shiver down spine
- pit in stomach
- heart in throat
- blood running cold

Metaphorical Entities:

- shadow (of fear)
- grip (of fear)
- clutch (of terror)
- wave (of panic)
- chill (running through)

Common Phrases

Bodily Responses:

- "heart was pounding"
- "heart was racing"
- "heart skipped a beat"
- "stomach dropped"
- "blood ran cold"
- "hair stood on end"

- "broke out in cold sweat"
- "went pale"
- "turned white"
- "breath caught"

Movement/Action:

- "frozen in fear"
- "frozen in my tracks"
- "rooted to the spot"
- "couldn't move"
- "paralyzed with fear"
- "scared stiff"
- "deer in headlights"

Spatial:

- "backed into a corner"
- "trapped like a [animal]"
- "nowhere to run"
- "no escape"
- "walls closing in"

Perception:

- "too scared to look"
- "couldn't believe my eyes"
- "afraid to find out"

Syntactic Patterns

"Feeling" patterns:

- "feeling [adjective]": feeling terrified, feeling panicked
- "felt [noun]": felt dread, felt terror

Body part + verb:

- "my heart [verb]": my heart stopped, my heart raced
- "my blood [verb]": my blood ran cold
- "my stomach [verb]": my stomach dropped

Modal + verb:

- "couldn't [verb]": couldn't move, couldn't breathe, couldn't think
- "can't [verb]": can't escape, can't run

Contextual Amplifiers

Temporal:

- sudden (sudden fear)
- instant (instant terror)
- immediate (immediate panic)

Degree:

- absolute (absolute terror)
- complete (complete panic)
- total (total fear)
- sheer (sheer terror)

Persistence:

- constant (constant dread)
- persistent (persistent anxiety)
- lingering (lingering fear)

Target Indicators

What fear is directed toward:

Specific threats:

- "afraid of [noun]": afraid of them, afraid of what's coming
- "scared [that clause]": scared that they'll find out
- "terrified [by/of]": terrified by the news

Vague threats:

- "something bad"
- "what's coming"
- "the unknown"
- "what might happen"

3. ANGER-RAGE METAPHORS

Bodily Experience Base

Anger manifests as: heat/flushing, muscle tension, jaw clenching, rapid breathing, pressure sensation, tunnel vision, energy surge, fist clenching.

Verbs

Heat/Burning (Intensity: Moderate to Extreme):

- boil, boiling, boiled
- burn, burning, burned
- seethe, seething
- steam, steaming
- simmer, simmering
- smolder, smoldering
- flare, flaring up
- heat up, heated

Pressure/Explosion (Intensity: Moderate to Extreme):

- explode, exploded, exploding
- erupt, erupted, erupting
- blow (up), blew up, blown up
- burst, bursting
- snap, snapped, snapping
- crack, cracked, cracking
- pop (off), popped

Physical Aggression (Intensity: Extreme):

- hit, strike, punch
- smash, smashing
- break, breaking, broke
- tear, tearing, tore
- rip, ripping
- destroy, destroying

Containment Loss (Intensity: Moderate to Extreme):

- lose it, lost it
- lose control
- come unglued
- come undone
- go off (on someone)

Adjectives

Temperature:

- hot, heated
- burning, burned up
- steaming, steamed
- boiling, boiled
- red-hot
- white-hot

Visual:

- red (seeing red, red-faced)
- flushed
- livid
- inflamed

Physical State:

- tense, tensed up
- wound up
- worked up
- fired up
- riled up

Intensity Levels:

- **Mild:** annoyed, irritated, bothered, peeved, ticked off
- **Moderate:** angry, mad, upset, pissed (off), irate, cross
- **Extreme:** furious, enraged, livid, incensed, apoplectic, ballistic

Nouns and Noun Phrases

Heat/Fire:

- fire (in the belly)
- flame (flames of anger)
- heat (heat of anger)
- burn (slow burn)

Pressure:

- pressure (building, mounting)
- steam (letting off steam, blow off steam)
- boiling point
- breaking point
- last straw

- tipping point

Physical Sensation:

- red mist
- blood boiling
- hackles up
- nerves on edge

Metaphorical Containers:

- powder keg
- time bomb
- volcano (about to erupt)

Common Phrases

Heat/Temperature:

- "blood is boiling"
- "blood boiling over"
- "hot under the collar"
- "all fired up"
- "burning with rage"
- "in the heat of anger"
- "temper flaring"

Pressure/Explosion:

- "about to explode"
- "ready to blow"
- "going to blow my top"
- "pressure building"
- "pressure mounting"
- "reached boiling point"
- "reached breaking point"
- "last straw"
- "had enough"
- "at the end of my rope"

Vision/Perception:

- "seeing red"
- "blind with rage"
- "blinded by anger"

Physical Action:

- "want to punch"
- "want to scream"
- "bit my tongue"
- "held my tongue"
- "clenched my fists"
- "jaw was clenched"
- "gritted my teeth"

Loss of Control:

- "lost it"
- "lost my cool"
- "lost my temper"
- "came unglued"
- "went ballistic"
- "went off"
- "blew up"
- "flew off the handle"

Syntactic Patterns

"So [adjective] (that)":

- "so angry (that)": so angry I could scream
- "so mad (that)": so mad I can't see straight

"Make(s) me [verb/adjective]":

- "makes me boil"
- "makes me furious"
- "makes my blood boil"

Progressive forms (building anger):

- "getting [adjective]": getting angrier, getting steamed
- "[adjective] and [adjective]": angrier and angrier
- "more and more [adjective]": more and more furious

"Can't/couldn't [verb]":

- "can't believe": can't believe they did that
- "can't stand": can't stand this anymore
- "couldn't hold back": couldn't hold back anymore

Contextual Amplifiers

Intensity:

- absolutely (absolutely furious)
- completely (completely enraged)
- beyond (beyond angry)
- so (so mad, so pissed)

Imminence:

- about to (about to explode)
- ready to (ready to blow)
- going to (going to lose it)

Justification (often precedes anger):

- "enough is enough"
- "this is too much"
- "I'm done"
- "no more"

Target Indicators

Direct target:

- "angry at/with [person/group]"
- "mad at [person/group]"
- "furious with [person/group]"
- "pissed at [person/group]"

Situation/action:

- "angry about [situation]"
- "mad that [clause]"
- "furious because [clause]"

System/institution:

- "the system"
 - "they" (unnamed powerful others)
 - "them" (outgroup)
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4. DISTRESS-ANGUISH METAPHORS

Bodily Experience Base

Distress manifests as: heaviness, downward pull, breathing difficulty, chest tightness, crying, slumped posture, fatigue, tears.

Verbs

Sinking/Falling (Intensity: Moderate to Extreme):

- sink, sinking, sunk
- drown, drowning, drowned
- go under, going under
- fall, falling, fell
- collapse, collapsing, collapsed
- drop, dropping, dropped
- descend, descending

Weight/Crushing (Intensity: Moderate to Extreme):

- crush, crushing, crushed
- weigh down, weighing down
- press, pressing, pressed
- burden, burdening
- overwhelm, overwhelming, overwhelmed
- suffocate, suffocating
- smother, smothering

Breaking/Fragmenting (Intensity: Extreme):

- break, breaking, broke, broken
- shatter, shattering, shattered
- crumble, crumbling, crumbled
- fall apart, falling apart
- come apart

Crying/Sobbing:

- cry, crying, cried
- sob, sobbing
- weep, weeping, wept
- tear up
- well up (eyes welling up)
- bawl, bawling

Adjectives

Weight:

- heavy, heavy-hearted
- weighed down
- burdened
- laden
- oppressed

Breathing:

- breathless
- suffocating
- stifled

Energy:

- drained
- exhausted
- depleted
- empty
- hollow

Physical State:

- broken
- shattered
- crushed
- devastated

Intensity Levels:

- **Mild:** sad, down, blue, bummed, upset
- **Moderate:** miserable, distressed, heartbroken, dejected
- **Extreme:** anguished, devastated, destroyed, inconsolable, despairing

Nouns and Noun Phrases

Weight:

- weight (weight of the world)
- burden (heavy burden)
- load (carrying a load)
- pressure (crushing pressure)
- heaviness

Water/Drowning:

- waves (waves of grief)
- tide (tide of sorrow)
- ocean (ocean of tears)
- depths (depths of despair)

Physical Sensations:

- lump in throat
- tightness in chest
- ache (heartache)
- pain (deep pain)
- pit in stomach
- hole (hole in my heart)
- emptiness

Metaphorical States:

- darkness (in darkness)
- abyss (staring into the abyss)
- void (feeling the void)
- bottom (rock bottom)

Common Phrases**Weight/Burden:**

- "weight of the world on my shoulders"
- "carrying a heavy burden"
- "weighing me down"
- "crushing weight"
- "too heavy to bear"
- "can't carry this anymore"
- "burdened by"

Drowning/Water:

- "drowning in sorrow/grief/problems"
- "drowning in debt"
- "head barely above water"
- "going under"
- "waves washing over me"
- "ocean of tears"
- "swimming in sadness"

Breathing/Suffocation:

- "can't breathe"
- "can't catch my breath"
- "suffocating under"
- "choking on [emotion]"
- "breath taken away"

Breaking/Shattering:

- "heart is broken"
- "feel broken"
- "shattered inside"
- "falling apart"
- "falling to pieces"
- "coming undone"
- "torn apart"

Crying:

- "can't stop crying"
- "broke down crying"
- "cried my eyes out"
- "tears won't stop"
- "sobbing uncontrollably"

Darkness/Depth:

- "in a dark place"
- "can't see the light"
- "bottomless pit"
- "rock bottom"
- "depths of despair"

Syntactic Patterns**"Can't" + action:**

- "can't take it anymore"
- "can't do this"
- "can't go on"
- "can't breathe"
- "can't handle this"

"Too [adjective] to [verb]":

- "too sad to function"
- "too heavy to carry"
- "too much to bear"
- "too painful to think about"

"Feel(s) like" + metaphor:

- "feels like drowning"
- "feels like I'm carrying"
- "feels like the weight of"
- "feels like I'm breaking"

Passive constructions (helplessness):

- "being crushed by"
- "being overwhelmed by"
- "being dragged down by"
- "being suffocated by"

Contextual Amplifiers

Persistence (key for distress):

- constant (constant sadness)
- endless (endless sorrow)
- never-ending (never-ending pain)
- always (always hurting)
- won't stop (tears won't stop)

Totality:

- completely (completely broken)
- utterly (utterly devastated)
- entirely (entirely overwhelmed)
- totally (totally crushed)

Accumulation:

- more and more (getting more and more unbearable)
- piling up (problems piling up)
- mounting (pressure mounting)

Target Indicators

Internal experience:

- "feeling [metaphor]": feeling crushed, feeling broken
- "my heart": my heart is heavy, my heart aches

External causes:

- "by [cause]": crushed by news, overwhelmed by circumstances
 - "because of [cause]": broken because of loss
 - "[situation] is [verb]-ing me": this is drowning me, life is crushing me
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5. SHAME-HUMILIATION METAPHORS

Bodily Experience Base

Shame manifests as: head dropping, eyes looking down/away, body curling inward, face heating/flushing, desire to hide, feeling small, chest caving.

Verbs

Shrinking/Diminishing (Intensity: Moderate to Extreme):

- shrink, shrinking, shrunk
- diminish, diminishing
- reduce, reducing
- wither, withering
- deflate, deflating
- crumble, crumbling
- cave in, caving in

Hiding/Disappearing (Intensity: Mild to Extreme):

- hide, hiding
- disappear, disappearing
- vanish, vanishing
- fade, fading
- sink (into ground)
- melt (into ground)
- dissolve, dissolving
- crawl (into a hole)

Looking Away (Intensity: Mild to Moderate):

- avert (eyes/gaze)
- look away, looked away

- turn away, turned away
- drop (eyes/gaze)
- lower (eyes/head)
- avoid (eyes/gaze)

Exposure (Intensity: Moderate to Extreme):

- expose, exposed
- reveal, revealed
- uncover, uncovered
- strip, stripped (bare)
- lay bare

Adjectives

Size/Stature:

- small
- tiny
- little
- insignificant
- diminished
- reduced
- lesser

Visibility:

- invisible
- hidden
- unseen
- overlooked
- ignored
- dismissed

Worth:

- worthless
- inadequate
- insufficient
- not enough
- lacking
- deficient
- inferior

Physical State:

- naked (emotionally)
- exposed
- bare
- vulnerable
- raw

Intensity Levels:

- **Mild:** embarrassed, self-conscious, awkward, uncomfortable
- **Moderate:** ashamed, humiliated, mortified
- **Extreme:** degraded, debased, worthless, destroyed (self-worth)

Nouns and Noun Phrases

Physical Sensations:

- heat (in face/cheeks)
- burn (burning cheeks)
- flush (face flushing)
- red face, crimson face
- lump in throat

Spatial Concepts:

- hole (want hole to swallow me)
- ground (want ground to open up)
- shadows (want to hide in)
- corner (shrink into corner)

Self-Perception:

- failure (I'm a failure)
- fraud (feel like a fraud)
- impostor (impostor syndrome)
- fake
- nothing (I'm nothing)
- nobody (I'm nobody)

Social Standing:

- disgrace
- embarrassment
- humiliation
- degradation
- loss of face

Common Phrases

Desire to Disappear:

- "want to disappear"
- "want to vanish"
- "want the ground to swallow me up"
- "want to crawl into a hole"
- "want to sink into the floor"
- "want to die" (from embarrassment)
- "want to melt into the ground"

Size/Stature:

- "feel so small"
- "felt tiny"
- "shrank back"
- "made me feel small"
- "put in my place"
- "cut down to size"

Hiding/Avoidance:

- "couldn't show my face"
- "can't face them"
- "couldn't look anyone in the eye"
- "couldn't meet their eyes"
- "had to look away"
- "want to hide"
- "wanted to hide my face"

Exposure:

- "felt exposed"
- "felt naked"
- "laid bare"
- "stripped bare"
- "all eyes on me" (negative context)
- "everyone looking"
- "everyone staring"

Self-Worth:

- "feel worthless"
- "feel like nothing"
- "feel like a failure"

- "not good enough"
- "never good enough"
- "such a fool"
- "such an idiot"
- "what was I thinking"

Physical Response:

- "face burning"
- "face on fire"
- "turned red"
- "went red"
- "blushed bright red"
- "face flushed"

Syntactic Patterns

"Couldn't" + face/show:

- "couldn't face [person/them]"
- "couldn't show my face"
- "couldn't look at [person/them]"
- "couldn't meet [their] eyes"

"Want to" + disappear/hide:

- "want to disappear"
- "wanted to hide"
- "just want to vanish"
- "wish I could disappear"

"Feel(s) like" + inadequacy:

- "feels like I'm not enough"
- "feel like a fraud"
- "feels like everyone knows"
- "feel like such a [negative self-label]"

"Made me feel" + diminishment:

- "made me feel small"
- "made me feel worthless"
- "made me feel insignificant"

Contextual Amplifiers

Public nature (increases shame):

- "in front of everyone"
- "publicly"
- "in public"
- "everyone saw"
- "they all know"

Repetition/Persistence:

- "again" (failed again, embarrassed again)
- "always" (always failing, always embarrassing myself)
- "every time"

Magnitude:

- "so [adjective]": so embarrassed, so ashamed
- "such a [noun]": such a fool, such a failure
- "completely" (completely humiliated)

Target Indicators**Self (most common in shame):**

- "I'm [negative attribute]"
- "feel like I [failed/am failing]"
- "I [verb] myself": I hate myself, I can't forgive myself

Social evaluation:

- "they think I'm [negative]"
- "everyone knows I'm [negative]"
- "what will they think"
- "what must they think of me"

Specific failure:

- "ashamed of [what I did/didn't do]"
- "embarrassed about [specific event]"
- "humiliated by [situation]"

Special Note: Shame vs. Guilt Language

Shame (self-focused): "I am bad/worthless/a failure" **Guilt (action-focused):** "I did something bad/wrong"

Shame uses identity language; guilt uses behavior language.

6. DISGUST METAPHORS

Bodily Experience Base

Disgust manifests as: nausea, gagging, throat tightening, tongue protruding, face scrunching, turning away, expulsion urge.

Verbs

Expulsion (Intensity: Moderate to Extreme):

- vomit, vomiting
- throw up, throwing up
- gag, gagging
- retch, retching
- heave, heaving
- purge, purging
- spit (out), spitting out
- expel, expelling
- reject, rejecting

Avoidance/Rejection (Intensity: Mild to Moderate):

- turn away, turning away
- recoil, recoiling
- shrink (from), shrinking from
- pull away, pulling away
- push away, pushing away
- repel, repelling, repelled

Physical Response:

- sicken, sickening, sickened
- nauseate, nauseating, nauseated
- revolt, revolting, revolted

Adjectives

Physical Reaction:

- sick, sickened

- nauseated, nauseous
- queasy
- ill
- revolted

Object Qualities:

- disgusting
- revolting
- repulsive, repugnant
- vile
- foul
- gross
- nasty
- filthy
- rotten
- putrid
- toxic
- contaminated
- tainted
- poisonous

Intensity Levels:

- **Mild:** unpleasant, distasteful, off-putting, icky
- **Moderate:** disgusting, gross, revolting, repulsive
- **Extreme:** vile, abhorrent, repugnant, sickening

Nouns and Noun Phrases

Physical Responses:

- nausea
- bile (rising bile, bile rising)
- gorge (gorge rising)
- stomach (stomach turning, churning)
- gag reflex

Metaphorical Substances:

- poison
- toxin
- contamination
- filth
- rot, rottenness

- slime
- sewage

Emotional States:

- revulsion
- repulsion
- abhorrence
- loathing

Common Phrases

Nausea/Physical Response:

- "makes me sick"
- "makes me want to vomit"
- "want to throw up"
- "stomach turning"
- "stomach churning"
- "feel sick"
- "feeling nauseous"
- "gorge rising"
- "bile rising"
- "turned my stomach"

Taste/Ingestion:

- "leaves a bad taste"
- "bitter taste in my mouth"
- "can't stomach it"
- "hard to swallow"
- "can't digest"
- "spit it out"

Contamination:

- "feel contaminated"
- "feel dirty"
- "feel tainted"
- "feel poisoned"
- "toxic [person/situation]"

Rejection:

- "can't stand it"
- "can't bear it"

- "won't tolerate it"
- "reject completely"
- "want it gone"
- "get it away from me"

Syntactic Patterns

"Make(s) me" + physical response:

- "makes me sick"
- "makes me gag"
- "makes me want to vomit"
- "made my stomach turn"

"Can't" + tolerate/consume:

- "can't stomach it"
- "can't swallow it"
- "can't take it"
- "can't stand it"

"[Subject] is/was" + adjective:

- "[person/thing] is disgusting"
- "[behavior] is revolting"
- "[situation] is toxic"

Progressive forms:

- "getting sicker and sicker"
- "more and more disgusting"
- "increasingly toxic"

Contextual Amplifiers

Intensity:

- absolutely (absolutely disgusting)
- utterly (utterly revolting)
- completely (completely vile)
- totally (totally gross)

Physical emphasis:

- physically (physically sick, physically repulsive)
- literally (literally makes me sick)

Target Indicators

Person/group:

- "[person] makes me sick"
- "[person] is disgusting"
- "[group] is toxic"

Behavior/action:

- "what [they] did is revolting"
- "[behavior] is disgusting"
- "the way [they act] sickens me"

Ideas/concepts:

- "[ideology] is toxic"
- "[concept] is poison"
- "that kind of thinking makes me sick"

Special Note: Disgust vs. Dissmell

Disgust: Something already taken in/experienced that needs expulsion

- "makes me sick" (already affected)
- "want to vomit" (get it out)
- "feel contaminated" (already touched by it)

Dissmell: Something detected that should be avoided before contact

- "smells bad" (warning sign)
 - "stay away from" (preventive)
 - "keep your distance" (avoid contact)
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7. DISSMELL METAPHORS

Bodily Experience Base

Dissmell manifests as: nose wrinkling, upper lip raising, head pulling back, creating distance, holding breath, facial "stink face."

Verbs

Physical Distancing (Intensity: Mild to Moderate):

- pull back, pulling back
- back away, backing away
- step back, stepping back
- recoil, recoiling
- withdraw, withdrawing
- retreat, retreating
- distance, distancing
- separate, separating

Avoidance (Intensity: Mild to Moderate):

- avoid, avoiding
- evade, evading
- dodge, dodging
- steer clear, steering clear
- keep away, keeping away
- stay away, staying away
- shun, shunning

Rejection (Intensity: Moderate):

- dismiss, dismissing
- brush off, brushing off
- turn up nose (at)
- look down on
- sneer (at)
- scoff (at)

Olfactory:

- smell, smells, smelling
- stink, stinks, stinking
- reek, reeks, reeking

Adjectives**Olfactory:**

- smelly
- stinky
- foul-smelling
- reeking
- malodorous
- rank

- rancid
- putrid

Undesirable Qualities:

- suspicious
- questionable
- dubious
- fishy
- off
- shady
- sketchy

Social Judgment:

- beneath (me/us)
- inferior
- unworthy
- undesirable
- distasteful

Intensity Levels:

- **Mild:** off-putting, questionable, suspicious
- **Moderate:** contemptible, beneath contempt, unworthy
- **Extreme:** (when combined with anger) contemptuous

Nouns and Noun Phrases

Olfactory:

- smell (bad smell, foul smell)
- stench
- odor (bad odor)
- reek
- whiff (caught a whiff)

Social Distance:

- distance (keeping distance)
- space (need space from)
- separation
- divide, division

Metaphorical Concepts:

- red flag(s)
- warning sign(s)
- bad vibe(s)

Common Phrases

Olfactory Metaphors:

- "smells fishy"
- "smells wrong"
- "smells bad"
- "stinks to high heaven"
- "something smells off"
- "doesn't smell right"
- "reeks of [corruption/lies/etc.]"
- "caught a whiff of [something bad]"

Distance/Avoidance:

- "keep my distance"
- "keeping away from"
- "stay away from"
- "steer clear of"
- "give [person/thing] a wide berth"
- "not going near"
- "wouldn't touch with a ten-foot pole"

Social Judgment:

- "look down on"
- "turn up my nose at"
- "beneath me"
- "beneath contempt"
- "not worth my time"
- "wouldn't associate with"

Detection/Warning:

- "something's off about"
- "something's not right about"
- "red flag"
- "warning signs"
- "bad vibes"
- "sketchy"
- "shady"

Syntactic Patterns

"Something [verb]" + negative:

- "something smells"
- "something's off"
- "something's wrong"
- "something's not right"

"[Person/thing] is/seems" + dubious adjective:

- "[person] seems shady"
- "[situation] is fishy"
- "[offer] seems suspicious"

"Keep/stay [away/distance]":

- "keep away from [person/thing]"
- "stay clear of [situation]"
- "keep my distance from [group]"

"Wouldn't" + association:

- "wouldn't trust"
- "wouldn't associate with"
- "wouldn't be caught dead with"

Contextual Amplifiers

Warning emphasis:

- definitely (definitely suspicious)
- clearly (clearly shady)
- obviously (obviously fishy)

Distance emphasis:

- far (stay far away)
- well (give a wide berth)
- completely (completely avoid)

Target Indicators

Person/group:

- "stay away from [person]"

- "[person] seems shady"
- "wouldn't trust [person]"

Situation:

- "[situation] smells fishy"
- "something's off about [situation]"
- "avoid [situation]"

Offer/opportunity:

- "[offer] seems too good to be true"
- "[deal] smells wrong"
- "red flags all over [opportunity]"

Special Note: Dissmell + Anger = Contempt

When dissmell combines with anger, it creates contempt, one of the most destructive patterns:

Contempt markers:

- "beneath contempt"
- "not even worth my time"
- "disgusted by the mere sight of"
- Combination of disgust vocabulary + anger intensity + dismissive distancing

Example: "They make me sick and I wouldn't piss on them if they were on fire" = disgust + anger + dissmell = contempt

8. INTEREST-EXCITEMENT METAPHORS

Bodily Experience Base

Interest manifests as: eyebrows pulling down slightly, gaze locking, leaning forward, breathing slowing, muscles engaged but not tense, attention narrowing.

Verbs

Attention Capture (Intensity: Mild to Moderate):

- catch (attention/eye)
- grab (attention)
- capture (attention)

- draw (attention)
- pull (attention)
- attract, attracting
- engage, engaging
- hook, hooking

Movement Toward (Intensity: Moderate):

- lean (toward/in/forward)
- pull toward
- draw toward
- gravitate toward
- turn toward

Mental Engagement (Intensity: Moderate to High):

- fascinate, fascinating
- intrigue, intriguing
- captivate, captivating
- absorb, absorbing
- engross, engrossing
- rivet, riveting

Exploration (Intensity: Mild to Moderate):

- explore, exploring
- investigate, investigating
- dig (into), digging into
- dive (into), diving into
- delve (into), delving into

Adjectives

Object Qualities:

- interesting
- intriguing
- fascinating
- captivating
- engaging
- compelling
- absorbing
- gripping
- riveting

Personal State:

- curious
- interested
- intrigued
- engaged
- absorbed
- hooked
- drawn
- attracted

Intensity Levels:

- **Mild:** curious, interested, intrigued
- **Moderate:** fascinated, engaged, absorbed, hooked
- **High:** captivated, riveted, enthralled, mesmerized

Nouns and Noun Phrases

Attention:

- attention (caught my attention)
- eye (caught my eye)
- focus (sharp focus)
- interest
- curiosity

Mental State:

- fascination
- intrigue
- absorption
- engagement

Metaphorical Magnets:

- pull (the pull of)
- draw (the draw of)
- attraction
- magnet

Common Phrases

Attention Capture:

- "caught my attention"
- "caught my eye"
- "grabbed my attention"

- "drew me in"
- "pulled me in"
- "couldn't look away"
- "can't stop watching"

Physical Response:

- "leaning in"
- "leaned forward"
- "sat up"
- "ears perked up"
- "eyes lit up"
- "eyes widened"

Mental Engagement:

- "got me thinking"
- "made me wonder"
- "want to know more"
- "need to find out"
- "dying to know"
- "curious about"

Immersion:

- "lost in thought about"
- "absorbed in"
- "engrossed in"
- "wrapped up in"
- "consumed by" (positive context)
- "can't get it out of my head"

Discovery:

- "want to explore"
- "digging into"
- "diving deep into"
- "going down the rabbit hole"
- "following the thread"

Syntactic Patterns

"Caught/grabbed my" + attention:

- "caught my eye"
- "caught my attention"

- "grabbed my interest"

"Can't" + stop engaging:

- "can't stop thinking about"
- "can't stop wondering"
- "can't look away"
- "can't wait to [learn/explore]"

"Want/need to" + explore:

- "want to know more"
- "want to understand"
- "need to find out"
- "have to explore"

"Getting/becoming more" + engaged:

- "getting more interested"
- "becoming more curious"
- "getting hooked"
- "increasingly fascinated"

Contextual Amplifiers

Intensity:

- really (really interesting)
- very (very intriguing)
- so (so fascinating)
- incredibly (incredibly engaging)

Suddenness:

- suddenly (suddenly interested)
- immediately (immediately hooked)
- instantly (instantly captivated)

Depth:

- deeply (deeply fascinated)
- thoroughly (thoroughly engaged)
- completely (completely absorbed)

Target Indicators

Subject matter:

- "interested in [topic]"
- "curious about [subject]"
- "fascinated by [phenomenon]"
- "intrigued by [mystery]"

Process:

- "want to learn [how/why]"
- "trying to understand [process]"
- "figuring out [mechanism]"

Possibility:

- "wondering what if"
- "curious what would happen"
- "interested to see"

Special Note: Interest vs. Joy

Interest: Gradual increase, building engagement, wanting more

- "getting more interested"
- "drawing me in"
- "want to keep going"

Joy: Decrease/relief, satisfaction, completion

- "that was satisfying"
- "feels good to finish"
- "weight lifted"

Interest pulls you in; joy releases you.

9. ENJOYMENT-JOY METAPHORS

Bodily Experience Base

Joy manifests as: smiling, shoulders dropping, chest opening, breathing easier, lightness, warmth, relaxation, upward sensation.

Verbs

Lightness/Rising (Intensity: Moderate to High):

- lift, lifting, lifted
- rise, rising
- float, floating
- soar, soaring
- fly, flying
- bounce, bouncing
- spring (in step)

Opening/Expanding (Intensity: Mild to Moderate):

- open (up), opening
- brighten, brightening, brightened
- lighten, lightening, lightened
- warm, warming, warmed
- glow, glowing
- radiate, radiating
- beam, beaming

Release (Intensity: Moderate to High):

- release, releasing
- relieve, relieving, relieved
- free, freeing
- unburden, unburdening

Smiling/Laughing:

- smile, smiling
- grin, grinning
- beam, beaming
- laugh, laughing
- light up (face/eyes)

Adjectives**Physical State:**

- light, light-hearted
- buoyant
- airy
- floating
- weightless

Emotional Quality:

- happy
- joyful, joyous
- delighted
- pleased
- glad
- cheerful
- content, contented
- relieved

Energy:

- bright
- sunny
- warm
- radiant
- glowing

Intensity Levels:

- **Mild:** pleased, glad, content, satisfied
- **Moderate:** happy, delighted, cheerful
- **High:** joyful, elated, ecstatic, overjoyed, euphoric

Nouns and Noun Phrases

Physical Sensations:

- lightness
- warmth (warm feeling)
- glow (inner glow)
- brightness
- spring (in step)

Relief:

- relief
- release
- weight lifted
- burden lifted
- load off

Metaphorical States:

- cloud nine
- seventh heaven
- high (on life, natural high)

- sunshine

Common Phrases

Lightness/Rising:

- "feel light as a feather"
- "walking on air"
- "floating on cloud nine"
- "on top of the world"
- "head in the clouds" (positive)
- "feet barely touching ground"
- "feel like flying"

Relief/Release:

- "weight lifted"
- "weight off my shoulders"
- "burden lifted"
- "load off my mind"
- "can breathe again"
- "breathe easier"
- "sigh of relief"
- "finally free"

Physical Response:

- "can't stop smiling"
- "can't wipe the smile off my face"
- "grinning ear to ear"
- "face lit up"
- "eyes lit up"
- "heart soaring"
- "spirits lifted"

Warmth/Opening:

- "warm feeling"
- "heart warming"
- "fills me with warmth"
- "glowing inside"
- "heart swelling"
- "heart full"

Position/Status:

- "on top of the world"
- "riding high"
- "feeling up"
- "things are looking up"
- "on the upswing"

Syntactic Patterns

"Feel(s) like" + lightness:

- "feels like a weight lifted"
- "feels like floating"
- "feel like I'm flying"

"Can't" + suppress joy:

- "can't stop smiling"
- "can't wipe the smile off"
- "can't contain my happiness"

"[Body part] + lift/light/warm":

- "my spirits lifted"
- "my heart soared"
- "my mood brightened"

"So [adjective]":

- "so happy"
- "so relieved"
- "so glad"
- "so pleased"

Contextual Amplifiers

Intensity:

- absolutely (absolutely delighted)
- completely (completely content)
- utterly (utterly joyful)
- pure (pure joy)

Relief emphasis:

- finally (finally happy, finally relieved)
- at last (at last content)

- such a (such a relief)

Target Indicators

Relief from distress:

- "relieved that [situation resolved]"
- "glad it's over"
- "happy it's done"
- "weight lifted when [problem solved]"

Connection:

- "happy to see [person]"
- "delighted to be with [person]"
- "joy in [relationship/togetherness]"

Achievement:

- "pleased with [outcome]"
- "happy about [success]"
- "glad [goal reached]"

Special Note: Joy as Decrease

Joy is unique among positive affects because it's triggered by *decrease* in intensity, not increase:

- Problem solved → intensity decreases → joy
- Tension released → intensity decreases → joy
- Reunion after separation → separation distress decreases → joy

This is why relief language is so central to joy metaphors.

10. SURPRISE-STARTLE METAPHORS

Bodily Experience Base

Surprise manifests as: eyebrows shooting up, eyes widening, sharp breath intake, body jumping or freezing, momentary stop of all activity.

Verbs

Physical Reaction (Intensity: Moderate to Extreme):

- jump, jumped
- jolt, jolted
- start, started
- flinch, flinched
- recoil, recoiled
- leap (out of skin)

Stopping (Intensity: Mild to Moderate):

- stop (in tracks)
- freeze, froze
- pause, paused
- halt, halted
- catch (breath)

Eye Response:

- widen (eyes)
- bulge (eyes)
- pop (eyes)
- open wide

Adjectives**Personal State:**

- surprised
- startled
- shocked
- stunned
- astonished
- amazed
- astounded
- dumbfounded
- flabbergasted
- taken aback

Quality of surprise:

- sudden
- unexpected
- out of the blue
- unforeseen

Intensity Levels:

- **Mild:** surprised, taken aback, caught off guard
- **Moderate:** startled, shocked, stunned
- **Extreme:** astonished, astounded, flabbergasted

Nouns and Noun Phrases

Physical Responses:

- gasp (sharp gasp)
- intake of breath
- heart skip (heart skipped a beat)
- jump (gave me a jump)
- start (gave me a start)

Metaphorical Concepts:

- bolt (bolt from the blue)
- bombshell
- shock
- jolt

Common Phrases

Physical Response:

- "eyes went wide"
- "eyes widened"
- "eyes popped"
- "jaw dropped"
- "mouth fell open"
- "did a double take"
- "heart skipped a beat"
- "nearly jumped out of my skin"
- "jumped out of my seat"

Breath:

- "caught my breath"
- "breath caught"
- "sharp intake of breath"
- "gasped"
- "drew a sharp breath"

Stopping:

- "stopped in my tracks"
- "stopped dead"
- "froze"
- "did a double take"
- "had to stop and process"

Unexpectedness:

- "out of nowhere"
- "out of the blue"
- "didn't see coming"
- "caught me off guard"
- "took me by surprise"
- "blindsided"
- "came out of left field"

Cognitive Impact:

- "couldn't believe my eyes"
- "couldn't believe my ears"
- "had to look twice"
- "did I just see/hear that"
- "wait, what?"

Syntactic Patterns

"[Action] when" + surprise:

- "jumped when [startling event]"
- "gasped when [unexpected reveal]"
- "froze when [surprising occurrence]"

"Didn't see/expect" + event:

- "didn't see that coming"
- "didn't expect [event]"
- "wasn't expecting [occurrence]"

"So [adjective]":

- "so surprised"
- "so shocked"
- "so unexpected"

"Made me" + startle response:

- "made me jump"
- "made me gasp"
- "made me stop"

Contextual Amplifiers

Unexpectedness:

- completely (completely unexpected)
- totally (totally out of the blue)
- absolutely (absolutely shocked)

Suddenness:

- suddenly (suddenly appeared)
- all of a sudden
- without warning

What Follows Surprise

Surprise is neutral - what comes *after* determines the emotion:

Surprise → Fear:

- "jumped, then realized it was dangerous"
- "startled, then panicked"

Surprise → Joy:

- "shocked, then so happy"
- "couldn't believe it, then thrilled"

Surprise → Interest:

- "unexpected, now I'm curious"
- "caught off guard, but intrigued"

Surprise → Anger:

- "blindsided and now furious"
- "shocked at the betrayal"

The surprise metaphor appears first, then other affect metaphors follow.

Target Indicators

Event:

- "surprised by [event]"
- "shocked when [occurrence]"
- "startled by [sudden change]"

Information:

- "surprised to learn [fact]"
- "shocked to hear [news]"
- "stunned by [revelation]"

Person:

- "surprised me when [person] did [action]"
 - "[person] caught me off guard"
-

11. CROSS-CULTURAL VARIATIONS

Important Notes

Embodied metaphors vary significantly across cultures. This section provides examples; comprehensive cultural adaptation requires native speaker consultation.

Temperature Metaphors

Anger as heat (widespread but not universal):

- **English:** "boiling mad," "hot-headed"
- **Spanish:** "estoy que ardo" (I'm burning)
- **Chinese:** 火大 (huǒ dà - fire big)
- **Arabic:** "دمه يغلي" (his blood is boiling)

BUT:

- **Some Indigenous cultures:** Anger as cold/distant rather than hot
- **Some Asian contexts:** Heat can indicate passion/enthusiasm, not just anger

Spatial Metaphors

Up/Down valence (common but varies):

- **English:** Happy = up, sad = down

- **Many European languages:** Similar pattern
- **Chinese:** Similar but with different nuances (上火 shàng huǒ - "rising fire" = anger/agitation)

BUT:

- **Some cultures:** Good/bad mapped to other spatial dimensions
- **Forward/backward:** Some cultures use advancement (forward = good) vs. regression (backward = bad)

Body-Based Metaphors

Heart location of emotion:

- **English:** "heartache," "heavy-hearted"
- **Many cultures:** Similar (corazón in Spanish, 心 xīn in Chinese)

BUT different organs for different affects:

- **English:** Gut for disgust, fear ("gut feeling," "stomach turning")
- **Chinese:** Liver for anger (肝火 gān huǒ - "liver fire")
- **Some African languages:** Different organs associated with different affects

Shame Expressions

Highly culturally variable:

Collectivist cultures (higher shame sensitivity):

- **Japanese:** 恥ずかしい (hazukashii) - rich vocabulary for gradations of shame
- **Metaphors:** losing face (losing social standing)
- **Body:** head lowering even more pronounced

Individualist cultures:

- **English:** Less elaborate shame vocabulary
- Often conflated with guilt or embarrassment
- **Metaphors** focus on size/visibility ("feel small," "want to disappear")

Face metaphors:

- **East Asian:** "Losing face" central concept
- **Mediterranean:** Honor/shame cultures - similar importance
- **Northern European:** Less emphasis on face, more on individual conscience

Water/Drowning Metaphors

Distress as drowning (widespread):

- **English:** "drowning in sorrow/work/debt"
- **Spanish:** "ahogado en" (drowned in)
- **French:** "noyé dans" (drowned in)

BUT context matters:

- **Island/maritime cultures:** May have more elaborate water metaphors
- **Desert cultures:** May use different environmental metaphors (buried in sand, scorched)

Joy/Relief

Weight lifting (common):

- **English:** "weight lifted"
- **Many European languages:** Similar

Light increasing (common):

- **English:** "brighten up," "see the light"
- **Many languages:** Similar

BUT different metaphorical bases:

- **Some cultures:** Release from bondage/constraint more prominent than weight
- **Some Asian contexts:** Harmony restored rather than burden lifted

Fear Expressions

Cold fear (widespread but not universal):

- **English:** "cold dread," "blood ran cold"
- **Many European languages:** Similar

Freezing/paralysis (widespread):

- **Most cultures:** Some version of immobilization metaphor

BUT different manifestations:

- **Some cultures:** Heart-based fear ("heart stopped") more prominent
- **Some contexts:** Fear as darkness/shadow more elaborate

Cultural Adaptation Checklist

When adapting this lexicon:

1. **Consult native speakers** from target culture
 2. **Review local literature** for metaphorical patterns
 3. **Consider:**
 - Collectivist vs. individualist values
 - High context vs. low context communication
 - Honor/shame vs. guilt/innocence cultural orientation
 - Environmental factors (climate, geography)
 - Religious/spiritual frameworks
 4. **Test detection** with native speaker validation
 5. **Adjust intensity calibrations** (some cultures express more/less intensely)
 6. **Note taboo topics** (some affects less acceptable to express publicly)
-

12. INTENSITY CALIBRATION GUIDE

Overview

Same metaphor can indicate different intensities based on context. This guide provides calibration factors.

Amplification Factors

Typographic:

- ALL CAPS: +30% intensity
- Multiple exclamation points (!!!): +20% per additional mark (max +60%)
- Elongation ("sooooo angry"): +25% intensity
- Combination (ALL CAPS + !!!): Multiply factors

Repetition:

- Word repetition ("so so so sad"): +15% per repetition (max +45%)
- Concept repetition ("drowning, can't breathe, going under"): +30% (cluster effect)

Intensifiers:

- Absolutely, completely, utterly, totally: +25%
- Very, really, so: +15%

- Extremely, incredibly: +35%
- Fucking, goddamn (profanity): +40%

Superlatives:

- Most [adjective] ever: +30%
- [Adjective]-est in my life: +35%
- Never been more [adjective]: +40%

Dampening Factors

Hedging:

- Kind of, sort of, a bit: -30%
- Somewhat, rather, fairly: -25%
- A little, slightly: -40%

Uncertainty:

- Maybe, perhaps, possibly: -20%
- I think, I guess: -25%
- Might be, could be: -30%

Negation:

- Not very [adjective]: -50%
- Not really [metaphor]: -60%
- Barely [metaphor]: -70%

Past tense (affect has passed):

- "Was feeling": -20% (compared to "feeling")
- "Felt": -30% (compared to "feel")
- "Used to feel": -50%

Context-Based Calibration

Casual conversation:

- Base intensity $\times$ 0.8 (people exaggerate casually)
- "Literally dying" $\neq$ extreme distress in casual context

Formal writing:

- Base intensity $\times$ 1.2 (understatement more likely)
- "Somewhat concerned" may indicate significant worry

Crisis context:

- Base intensity $\times 1.3$ (people minimize in crisis)
- "A bit worried" in crisis = high fear

Cultural context:

- High-expressiveness cultures: $\times 0.8$
- Low-expressiveness cultures: $\times 1.3$

Intensity Gradients by Affect**Fear:**

- 0.0-0.3: nervous, worried, anxious, uneasy
- 0.3-0.6: scared, frightened, afraid, alarmed
- 0.6-0.8: terrified, panic-stricken
- 0.8-1.0: petrified, paralyzed with fear, terror

Anger:

- 0.0-0.3: annoyed, irritated, bothered
- 0.3-0.6: angry, mad, pissed off
- 0.6-0.8: furious, enraged, livid
- 0.8-1.0: ballistic, explosive rage, blind fury

Distress:

- 0.0-0.3: sad, down, bummed, blue
- 0.3-0.6: miserable, heartbroken, devastated
- 0.6-0.8: anguished, crushed, shattered
- 0.8-1.0: inconsolable despair, broken

Shame:

- 0.0-0.3: embarrassed, self-conscious, awkward
- 0.3-0.6: ashamed, humiliated
- 0.6-0.8: mortified, deeply ashamed
- 0.8-1.0: annihilated (self-worth), utterly degraded

Interest:

- 0.0-0.3: mildly curious, intrigued
- 0.3-0.6: interested, engaged, absorbed
- 0.6-0.8: fascinated, captivated
- 0.8-1.0: enthralled, obsessed, consumed by curiosity

Joy:

- 0.0-0.3: pleased, content, glad
- 0.3-0.6: happy, delighted
- 0.6-0.8: joyful, elated
- 0.8-1.0: ecstatic, euphoric, blissful

Calibration Algorithm

```
def calibrate_intensity(base_intensity, context):
    intensity = base_intensity

    # Typographic amplification
    if context['all_caps']:
        intensity *= 1.3
    if context['exclamation_count'] > 1:
        intensity *= (1 + 0.2 * min(context['exclamation_count'] - 1, 3))

    # Intensifiers
    if context['has_intensifier']:
        intensity *= context['intensifier_factor'] # 1.15 to 1.4

    # Dampeners
    if context['has_hedge']:
        intensity *= 0.7
    if context['has_negation']:
        intensity *= 0.4

    # Context type
    intensity *= context['context_factor'] # 0.8 to 1.3

    # Cap at 1.0
    return min(intensity, 1.0)
```

13. CONTEXT-DEPENDENT INTERPRETATIONS

Ambiguous Metaphors

Some metaphors require context to determine affect:

"Heavy":

- **Distress:** "heavy burden," "heavy heart" (weight metaphor)

- **Shame:** "heavy with guilt" (moral weight)
- **Fatigue/Interest declining:** "feels heavy" (losing energy)

Disambiguation: Check surrounding language

- Distress markers: can't carry, drowning, crushed
- Shame markers: guilt, wrong, failed
- Interest markers: boring, tired, dragging

"Cold":

- **Fear:** "cold dread," "blood ran cold"
- **Dissmell:** "cold shoulder," "icy reception"
- **Lack of joy/interest:** "cold response," "left me cold"

Disambiguation: Check context

- Fear markers: scared, terrified, frozen
- Dissmell markers: distant, reject, avoid
- Low interest markers: boring, dull, unengaged

"Burning":

- **Anger:** "burning with rage"
- **Shame:** "face burning" (blushing)
- **Interest:** "burning curiosity" (high engagement)

Disambiguation: Check target and surrounding affect

- Anger markers: furious, mad, want to
- Shame markers: embarrassed, couldn't look
- Interest markers: curious, want to know

Irony and Sarcasm

Irony use inverts meaning:

Literal: "Oh great, just great" = joy **Irony:** "Oh great, just great" = anger/distress

Detection markers:

- Contradiction with context ("great" + negative situation)
- Exaggeration ("best day ever" + obviously bad day)
- Typographic irony markers ("great" in quotes, "great 🙄")

Metaphor Mixing

Multiple affects can co-occur:

Fear + Anger:

- "Frozen with rage" (paralyzed but angry)
- "Terrified and furious" (both present)

Distress + Shame:

- "Crushed and humiliated"
- "Broken and worthless" (common in depression)

Interest + Joy:

- "Fascinated and delighted"
- "Captivated and happy" (learning joy)

Pattern: Both affect vocabularies present, often connected with "and"

Temporal Markers

Affect timing affects interpretation:

Present progressive = current state:

- "I'm drowning" = currently in distress
- "Getting angrier" = anger building now

Simple past = resolved:

- "I was drowning" = was in distress (now resolved?)
- "I got angry" = anger occurred (now over?)

Present perfect = ongoing impact:

- "I've been drowning" = distress persists
- "I've gotten so angry" = anger accumulated

Future = anticipatory:

- "I'm going to explode" = anger building toward release
- "Will be devastated" = anticipating distress

Domain Specificity

Same metaphor, different domains = different implications:

Work domain:

- "Drowning" in work = distress about workload
- Common, may not indicate crisis

Relationship domain:

- "Drowning" in relationship problems = significant distress
- More concerning, possible crisis

Financial domain:

- "Drowning" in debt = extreme distress
- High-risk indicator

Calibration: Weight by domain + personal importance

Literal vs. Metaphorical

Some phrases have literal and metaphorical uses:

Literal: "I'm freezing" (temperature) **Metaphorical:** "I'm freezing" (fear)

Disambiguation clues:

- Weather/temperature context = literal
- Threat/danger context = metaphorical fear
- Social context = metaphorical shame/fear

Mixed: "Cold fear" = metaphorical (fear) using literal sensation (cold)

Population-Level Patterns

Individual metaphor = one data point Pattern across population = signal

Example: "Drowning"

- One person: "drowning in work" = individual distress
- 1000 people in same week: "drowning in work" = systemic problem

Pattern detection requires:

- Temporal clustering (many at once)
 - Demographic clustering (same group)
 - Target clustering (same toward what)
-

USAGE EXAMPLES

Detection Pipeline Example

Input text: "I'm so angry I could explode. They make my blood boil. I've had enough of this."

Step 1: Metaphor identification

- "explode" → anger (pressure/explosion)
- "blood boil" → anger (heat)
- "had enough" → anger (limit reached)

Step 2: Intensity rating

- "so angry" → intensifier (+25%)
- "could explode" → extreme vocabulary (base 0.8)
- "blood boil" → extreme vocabulary (base 0.9)
- "had enough" → moderate (base 0.6)

Step 3: Aggregation

- Primary affect: Anger
- Multiple anger metaphors = confirmation
- Average intensity: 0.8 (high anger)
- Cluster amplification: +20%
- **Final intensity: 0.96** (near maximum)

Step 4: Target identification

- "They" = outgroup or specific others
- Target: External group/person

Step 5: Context tagging

- No domain keywords present
- Check user history/thread context

Output:

```
{  
  "primary_affect": "anger",  
  "intensity": 0.96,  
  "confidence": 0.92,  
  "target": "other_person_group",  
  "metaphors_detected": ["explode", "blood_boil", "had_enough"],  
  "context": "to_be_determined"
```

}

APPENDIX: SEARCHABLE INDEX

By Verb

A

- avert → shame
- avoid → dissmell, fear

B

- back away → dissmell
- boil → anger
- break → distress, anger
- burn → anger, shame

C

- catch (attention) → interest
- crush → distress
- cry → distress

D

- disappear (want to) → shame
- drown → distress

E

- explode → anger
- expose → shame

F

- freeze → fear
- float → joy

H

- hide → shame, fear

J

- jump → surprise

L

- lift → joy
- look away → shame

P

- paralyze → fear
- pull back → dissmell

R

- reject → disgust

S

- shrink → shame
- sink → distress
- smell → dissmell

T

- trap → fear

V

- vomit → disgust

W

- weigh down → distress

By Adjective

Anger: hot, burning, boiling, furious, enraged **Fear:** cold, frozen, terrified, scared **Distress:** heavy, crushed, broken, sad **Shame:** small, worthless, exposed, embarrassed **Disgust:** sick, revolting, toxic, disgusting **Dissmell:** fishy, shady, suspicious, off **Interest:** fascinating, intriguing, engaging **Joy:** light, happy, relieved, delighted **Surprise:** shocked, stunned, startled

END OF APPENDIX B

Document Status: Version 1.0

Last Updated: January 2025

Next Review: Quarterly updates based on detection accuracy data

Contributions: Submit additions/corrections to metaphor database committee